NEWSHAPER

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Project Description

Newshaper is a tabletop interactive system which deals with re-contextualization of daily news items gathered from live news feeds. It allows users to create their own relational networks and 'emotional maps' based on actual live news streamed from internet. Due to the dynamic nature of live data streams system constantly creates different content for users and due to manipulations done by the users it generates different visual results of the same content. In a more general sense, users of Newshaper system shape their own perception about the daily news and share their vision with other users. System allows them to save their designed structure.

Most of the time, mass media sources deliver the daily news in a context. This context creates a meta-meaning that usually effects the simple meaning of the news. By tagging, by categorizing, by geo-locating, by making it popular or unpopular mass media is shaping the perception of the daily news items in a different perspective. Newshaper allows their users to break this pre-defined structures which have been delivered by the source. After users shape their own news scape, system also allows to see the comparison between pre-defined structure and user defined structure in a visual way.

By using Newshaper users might define their feelings about news and importance of each item. The users can save their mood and the news map they created as a proof of that particular moment. Average of all sessions recorded by users creates the overall mood of the day in order to display the common thoughts and feelings about the actual news provided by media sources.

Technical Details

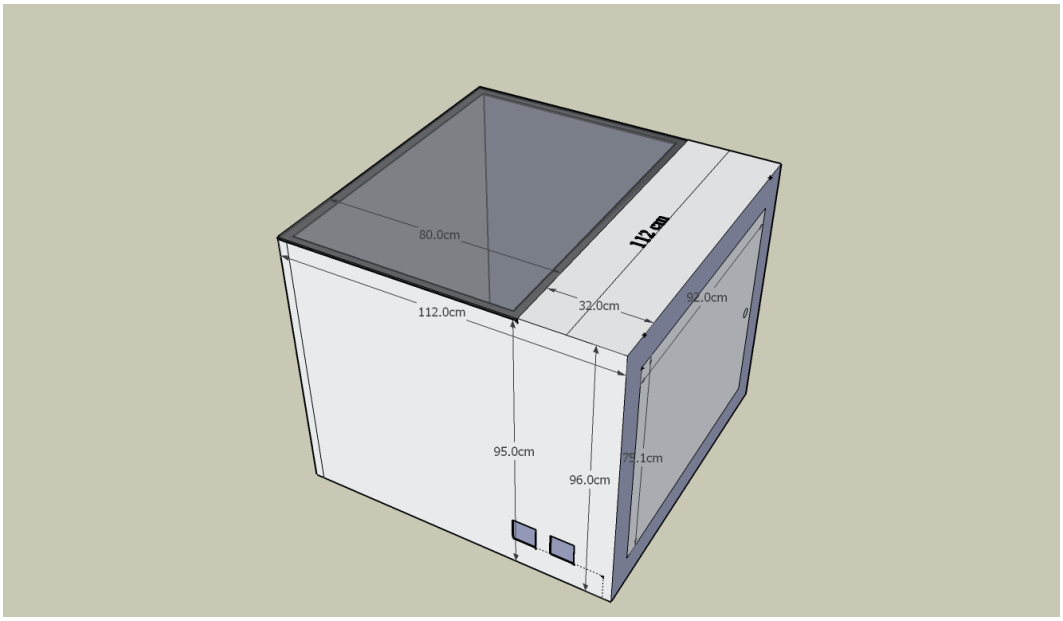
Newshaper installation consists a tabletop projection, a camera tracks the shadows on the table to create interactivity and a dynamic database that constantly gathers live news items from internet. Newshaper software has three different functions; it automatically streams news items every minute and place them onto the table, it allows users to modify the visual look and organization of the news landscape by using their hands and it gives the opportunity to save the designed structure of any given moment.

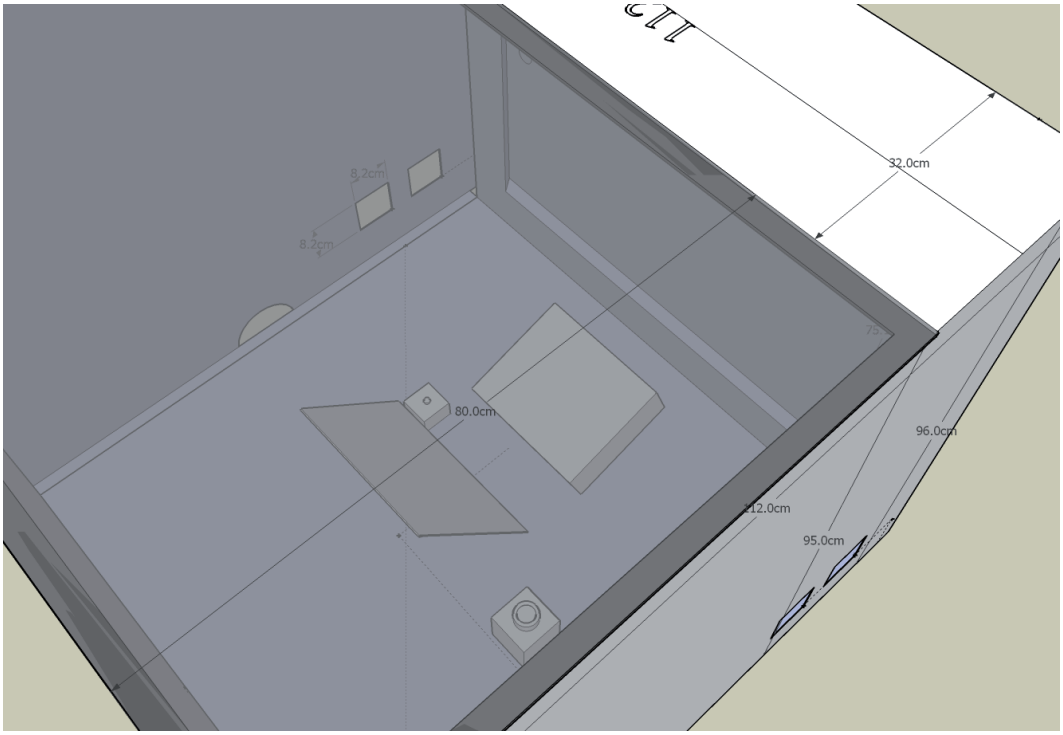
Technical Requirements

- Computer: The installation needs an medium level computer with a powerful graphic card, 2 GB of memory and Windows XP.
- Projector: Depends of the luminosity of the place. In a dark environment a projector with a native resolution of 1024*768 with 2000 lumens and 1000:1 contrast should work fine.
- Camera: 60fps firewire camera.
- Camera lens: The camera lenses will be choose according with the distance between the camera and the table.
- Camera Filter: Filter which function is to filter out the projection to focus on the tracking on the hands of the people.
- IR Light: A matrix of IR leds that illuminates the table.
- Table: A white wooden table of aproximately 120 cm w, 90 cm h and 90 cm d.
- Internet connection: It is crucial to ensure a well of the installation to have a fast and stable internet connection.
- A display will be also needed but only for setting up the installation.

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Sketch that explains the setup of the installation with table, camera and projector.





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Please Check **www.newshaper.net** for images and videos!